

Polar Bear

Ursus maritimus

Vulnerable

Fact Sheet · Colouring Page · Activities

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Polar Bear — Fact Sheet

Scientific name	Ursus maritimus
Conservation status	Vulnerable
Region	Arctic — Canada, Russia, Norway (Svalbard), Greenland, and USA (Alaska)
Habitat	Arctic sea ice, coastlines, and open water of the Arctic Ocean
Diet	Carnivore — primarily ringed and bearded seals; occasionally fish, birds, and vegetation
Weight	350–700 kg (male), 150–250 kg (female)
Size	Up to 3 m standing; 1.3 m at shoulder
Lifespan	25–30 years in the wild
Wild population	Around 26,000 worldwide across 19 subpopulations

Did You Know?

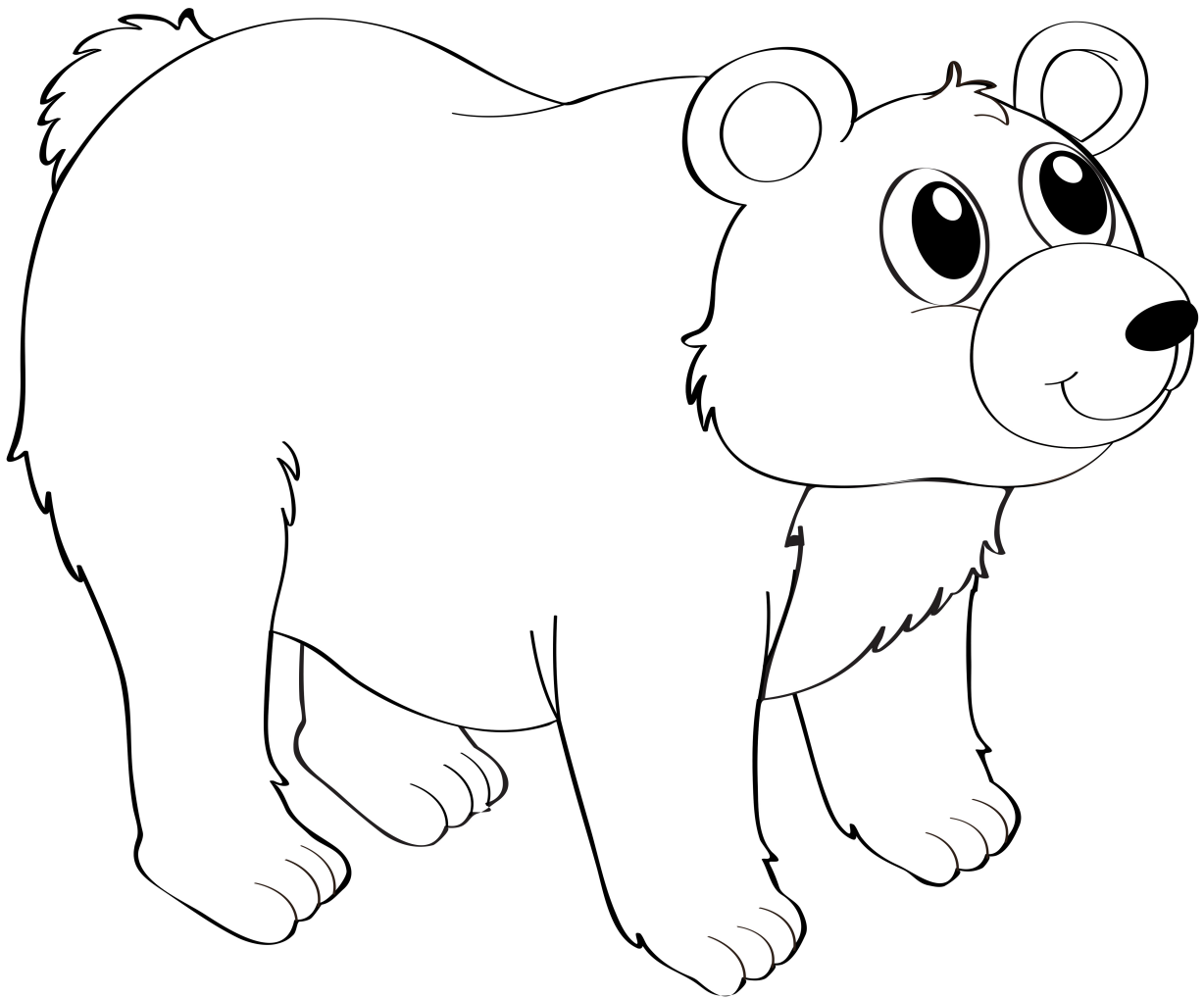
- Polar bear fur is actually transparent — each hair is a hollow tube that scatters light to appear white!
- Their skin underneath is black to absorb as much heat from the sun as possible.
- Polar bears can swim continuously for days — one was tracked swimming 687 km over 9 days.
- They hunt almost entirely on sea ice, waiting motionless at seal breathing holes for hours.
- A polar bear's paws are enormous — up to 30 cm across — acting like snowshoes on thin ice.
- Females den under the snow for months in winter, giving birth to tiny cubs weighing just 600 g.

Threats to Survival

1. Climate change — melting sea ice reduces their hunting grounds
2. Pollution — industrial chemicals accumulate in their fat
3. Oil and gas development in fragile Arctic habitats
4. Increased human encounters as ice retreats toward shore

Colour Me: Polar Bear

Polar bears appear white or creamy yellow. Their large black nose and dark eyes stand out against the bright Arctic fur.



Polar Bear — Activities

Word Search

Find all 8 words hidden in the grid.

T	C	G	W	T	X	P	I	Z	J	E	F
S	L	O	S	F	A	Z	N	S	I	Y	W
W	I	R	E	X	L	C	X	G	C	I	V
I	M	X	A	E	I	L	M	V	E	O	X
M	A	W	L	T	B	B	V	G	B	D	Q
M	T	P	C	R	Z	P	L	Q	E	T	E
I	E	R	S	A	K	Q	U	G	R	U	B
N	A	M	K	P	O	L	A	R	G	N	L
G	Q	A	U	P	Z	B	H	E	H	D	D
S	E	P	L	O	Q	C	E	D	L	R	D
P	D	Q	J	K	Q	O	U	A	H	A	Z
C	A	E	Z	L	U	I	K	C	R	I	Z

POLAR	ARCTIC	ICEBERG	SEAL
CLIMATE	SWIMMING	TUNDRA	BEAR

Match It Up

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

Polar Bear		Arctic's top predator
Sea ice		where female bears give birth
Climate change		the polar bear's main prey
Seal		melting the polar bears' home
Den		polar bear's hunting platform

Fill in the Blanks

1. Polar bear fur is actually _____, not white.
2. Their skin is _____ to absorb heat from the sun.
3. The biggest threat to polar bears is _____ change.
4. There are around _____ polar bears left in the wild.

Answers: transparent / black / climate / 26,000

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